

Worship - Knowledge Is Not Enough

Never in my whole life have I been in a conference like the ones since October and these first few days of this one. Here I am thinking that whatever God pours out on me, I can handle. Then you come up and mess me up so badly I can hardly talk.

I am trying to sit back there while waves of His glory come over me so strongly that they neutralize me to almost nothing. After these years of meditation and assimilating, it seems there is just one problem: the more I know, the less I get to teach.

It is good to be free.

God is so in love with you. Sometimes before you can say a single word, He will pull a person apart in every direction He operates in, just because people need Him.

I have been striving in a language I can understand to explain what has been happening. It is like looking down a long road versus looking down a short one. The problem is looking down the short road. If a man does not begin to walk in the Spirit somewhere, he cannot see the goals on the short road. He always wants to take the long road, and it is lined with flesh, because he cannot see the desired results on the short road.

If I could convince you to go after the compassion of God with the same veracity with which we go after His gifts and power, I would have convinced you of a shortcut.

In God attempting to answer my prayer, He just about neutralized me. I know He cannot pour out more on me than I can handle, but every time He takes me right to the limit. I tell God, "I want all You have, and You can add a little bit more to that. And yes, I want that order fulfilled yesterday."

So He tries to pour it out on me. In the state I am walking, He reaches my capacity pretty fast. Then, when He gives me a little more, I cannot stand up under it. That is when I break down and do not know how to handle it. I have had to be taken out of services several times, not just here but also on the road.

If I could convince you of His compassion, I would be doing something.

Go to 1 Corinthians 12. Begin with verse 1:

Now concerning spiritual gifts, brethren, I would not have you ignorant.

If there is any area where we seem ignorant, it is concerning spiritual gifts. Paul goes on to outline the nine gifts of the Spirit that empower and qualify the eight operations of God. These spiritual gifts and callings are not something He wants us ignorant of.

The nine gifts not only empower but also qualify the operations. The eighth operation of God is diversities of tongues. How could you qualify for that operation and not speak with tongues?

Then Paul begins to list these callings in verse 27:

Now ye are the body of Christ, and members in particular.

And God hath set some in the church, first apostles, secondarily prophets, thirdly teachers, after that miracles, then gifts of healings, helps, governments, diversities of tongues.

Then he goes on:

Are all apostles? are all prophets? are all teachers? are all workers of miracles?

Have all the gifts of healing? do all speak with tongues? do all interpret?

We do not all have the same calling that takes that series of giftings to empower and qualify it. When he says, "Do all speak with tongues? Do all interpret?" he is talking about tongues in relationship to the simple gift of interpretation, not personal edification. If he were talking about tongues for personal edification, he would have said yes. But not all have the gift of interpretation.

That becomes evident once you know His voice and know how to interpret, and then hear some of the interpretations going on in the Body today that agree with the walk of the flesh.

Then verse 31 says:

But covet earnestly the best gifts: and yet shew I unto you a more excellent way.

That word covet is strong. In the Ten Commandments He said, "Thou shalt not covet," but here He uses that same strong word to tell you to covet the best gifts.

When I first saw God's power in operation, I did not know God's hand was on me or that the call on me would make me desire those gifts as qualifying giftings for the office He had called me to. I thought everybody was hungry to operate in His power.

I can covet strongly. I can shove a plate away and not look at it again for a long time. I can lock myself up with nothing but my mind and God for days. When Paul said to covet earnestly the best gifts, I could covet.

Then he has the audacity to say, "Yet I show you a more excellent way."

A more excellent way to do what? To covet and receive. There should not have been a chapter break before 1 Corinthians 13. It should have continued without interruption.

After you have coveted, fasted, prayed, and everything else, Paul says, "Let me show you the more excellent way."

Though I speak with the tongues of men and of angels, and have not charity,

I am become as sounding brass, or a tinkling cymbal.

Do you mean the more excellent way to covet is to go after the love of God with the same veracity with which I went after the gifts?

I have been in this a long time. I have enjoyed operating in His power, and I could enjoy a walk with God as far as any man's teachers had brought me. But when the Holy Spirit touched me with the compassion of God, my whole world changed.

Last February, which I have talked about every conference since, they had to take me out of the March conference. I hardly had any idea what was happening to me. In October's conference, I was taken right to the line, and I managed to hold on until enough of it passed.

I thought, "God, when I come out here to preach, I am not supposed to be the one immobilized."

John 17 is where I found my answer. I said, "Lord, what happened to me that caused me to weep for nine hours?"

Jesus said in John 17 that the world may know, Father, that You love them with the same love You love Me.

The same love my Father loved Jesus with is what He touched me with that day. He touched my spirit with it. The moment He touched me, it caused me to weep for nine hours. To have the same love He loved Jesus with activated in me for a period of time was almost more than I could handle.

When God began to give me answers for this, the power followed it like it had never followed the ministry before.

A friend asked me to go to a meeting of an evangelist who probably had one of the most powerful healing ministries in the world. We went. Because my friend had status, we got status chairs. They moved me three times. When they got him up to play, I was fair game for the movers. Some people of higher esteem moved me three times, and I took the lower seat. I was chuckling inside.

The singers sang, and I kept waiting for the ripples of glory to come over the crowd, but they did not come like I was accustomed to. It was good worship. But when that minister came out and started worshipping, that is when the anointing came to the crowd and began to do miracles.

I cannot help it; the teacher in me cannot just sit in a service. I have to assess the whole thing. I have to feel it and know it. I have to know God's mind in it and what is happening.

When he sang, God came. Then came streams of testimonies.

When they began to wind down, my friend was delayed in coming to get me. I tried to get out the door where the dignitaries were walking out, but I got stopped there too. I stopped, turned around, and the Spirit of God came on me.

Many people's exterior took on a plastic tint. In that moment, God gave me the revelation. He made me know everything He wanted me to know in a second.

He said, "Many of these are just sending their outer man through the meeting. The real person stayed home, and they are standing there watching."

Then He told me, "This anointing of compassion I have been trying to pour out on you belongs to the healing family. It has a presence in it that deals with people's spirits and makes changes. If I could turn that anointing loose in here, they would have the best of both worlds. They would have absolute signs and wonders, as seen very seldom, and they would also have the same level of signs and wonders pouring out on the inside of them through compassion, reducing them to change."

Later, I saw a massive auditorium with doors so wide that groups of people came in at once. As soon as they got inside, they buckled over and began to weep. Then I saw the parking lot, where people could hardly get out of their cars. They were falling down and weeping, and their whole lives were changing. Then cars were turning in because people driving by suddenly had God come into their cars and had to turn in.

That answered an age-old question for me: how did the old-timers have such a presence that people could get on the grounds and be reduced to revival in the parking lot?

He said, "Son, I want both worlds. I want creative miracles, and I also want to operate in the gifts of healings in such a way that I can come upon people with My supernatural power and start making permanent change on the inside of them, where all change comes from. I want to pull down little strongholds and reduce them to surrender by the sheer power of My presence."

He said people would no longer be able to stand along the walls and accuse us of paying people to testify of miracles.

Then I began to understand. He wanted me to go back to the closet and finish receiving.

I had opportunity to talk to different ones, and I kept saying, "I have to go back."

I scheduled time to go back. The devil was afraid of it. He threw everything. It made me wonder what he was so afraid of me finding out in God's presence this time.

God had mercy on me. I was able to get away enough in different seasons to seek Him and understand what He was trying to do.

Remember when I read to you a portion about your Father, and what Jesus said to Nicodemus about who your father is? Show no disrespect to your earthly father, but when you are born from above, who is your Father?

I began to understand that there are several parts to my spirit. There is a part that craves and discerns knowledge. It wants to know all about God, discern Him, understand His Word, and understand the operation of His kingdom. I want His mind to be able to drop into me, and I can understand what He is talking about because I have a new nature that can discern spiritual things.

That is part of what your spirit has a capacity for: to know and understand God.

But there is another part of my spirit. One part discerns and craves knowledge of God. Another part has the capacity to love.

It took me a while to realize He loves me with the same love He loves Jesus with. That means this born-again spirit of mine has a capacity to hold the love of God, the same love He loved Jesus with.

You want to talk about signs and wonders? There is a compartment in my spirit designed and created by God to hold His love. I mean the same love He poured out on Jesus. The same love He loved Him with, He loves me with. There is a part of my new creation that has the capacity not only to hold that love, but to become a reservoir other people can drink from.

Do you know how far He had to break this down for me? He had to give me a parable. We call it the parable of the nerd girl.

Here is a computer nerd, no disrespect. My wife says I am one. They give him a little cubicle in the great corporation because he does not care. He comes to work with a pencil pack leaking on his shirt, one pants leg stuffed in his sock, one shirt tail out, and buttons one button higher than they should be. His pants leg does not stay in the sock long because he has high-water pants on.

His brain puts out so much power there is not even enough left over to run his body. He forgets to eat. Knowledge. He is not happy unless he is writing a program and pushing it to the limit. Great competition is going on between other nerds. "I am faster, and I can break it faster than him." Knowledge.

It does not matter that the boss sends the best-looking secretary to get coffee. She walks by his cubicle, and he does not even look up.

Until that day she gets transferred, and the computer nerd girl comes in. She has thick glasses, bed hair, a thin cotton dress, one white sock with a pink rim around the top and one without, carrot lips, and a green health-food drink. She walks down the hall.

Knowledge. Knowledge. Knowledge.

She goes by his cubicle, and then it happens.

From then on, something in him cannot be satisfied with knowledge. It can only be satisfied in the presence of his sweetie pie.

There is a capacity in me that is not satisfied just knowing about God. There is a capacity in my human spirit, a pool of compassion, that can be filled up with God. I can only find it by spending time in His presence.

Praying in tongues cannot give me what worship does. Worship cannot give me what praying in tongues does. Praying in tongues cannot give me what fasting can, and fasting cannot give me what praying in tongues can. But praying in tongues delivered me to all those limbs that can only do what they do.

If you say, "I will just pray in tongues a lot and not fast," it will not work, because He will keep delivering you to the fasting limb. If you say, "I will just pray in tongues a lot and not worship," it will not work, because He will keep delivering you to the worship limb so worship can accomplish in you what tongues cannot.

Did tongues accomplish all of it? Yes, because tongues revealed to you the next thing God was delivering you from and into that would change your life.

There is a place in Him where, when a person breaks into a new realm, you do not necessarily carry the exact schedule that broke you into it. Once you begin to receive from Him, God does not particularly fellowship with your fasting schedule, the cubicle hours you put in praying in tongues, or the exact days you set aside.

The devil will say, "You know why that happened? Because you missed praying in tongues this morning." Or, "See there, you missed two or three weeks because you were out doing what God called you to do, serving people."

What you attained in your closet is not going to disappear when He is using it to minister to people. God does not fellowship with the mere schedule. He comes and fellowships with the permanent change those things produced in your life.

I can boldly say that if I never prayed another day in my life, I would retain what I have already received from Him, because I would be using it to serve people. I might even advance to some degree by spending so much time in His presence in the services I preach.

But to advance with the advancement, my capacity for the more excellent way is increasing. In this compassion He is opening up, God was revealed as my Father. I have been introduced to a Being who is so in love with you that He will do anything to reach you.

It is not hard to love somebody your Father loves that much. And that is you.

It is my desire that these things do not bring you into condemnation. I do not care what kind of schedule you have. He will honor any time you give Him. He even prorates things.

You intended to seek Him, fast, and pray, and the devil outmaneuvered you and took the time away. Do you think that heart desire will be left undone? That kind of desire will pull God in on a day-by-day basis.

Now, I want to address those of you who have been ordained. God thinks you are ready. He can give you instruction. Usually the instruction He gives me causes me to stretch. Most of the time I have to stretch a little to attain to it, but I do not mind.

During this time of breaking in, remember that what got you to break in is not necessarily what you must maintain in exact schedule to keep what He gives you.

The first time He sent me to my closet to find out about worship, I could feel His favor on four to six hours. I tried not to make it less than four and usually felt released around six. It was frightening how rapidly things began to happen. It had never happened before, and it made me wonder why I had been so slow to see it.

Keeping in mind, it is people you are doing this for. They cannot be excluded from the equation. It is religion that causes men to isolate themselves and remove themselves from people. Some have taken vows of silence and locked themselves up for life instead of obeying "Go ye and preach."

The city of Zion did not work because God did not call you to hole up with each other so nobody would treat you mean.

All this time you spend in the closet is for opening avenues of compassion so your Father can do what He has always desired to do. When He starts using you on a whole new scale and a lot of your time is taken, you do not lose what you gained.

The first time, it was four to six hours. The last time I kept pressing Him and pressing Him, He said, "If you want to break through quickly, maintain seven hours of holding your spirit in My presence in worship."

You have a capacity not only to receive, but to flow through. God wants to turn His love loose, and He wants to do it through you.

In John 14, Jesus said:

In my Father's house are many mansions:
if it were not so, I would have told you.
I go to prepare a place for you.

He said, in effect, "I ought to know. I occupy one of those dwelling places as His firstborn. I go to prepare a place for you, that where I am, this room, this dwelling place I occupy with the Father as His firstborn, I will come again and receive you unto Myself."

Where is He? He went by way of the cross, prepared this place for me in the Father, and came and received me unto Himself.

He said, "The same glory, Father, that You have given Me, I give unto them." What glory did the Father give Him? He gave Him that standing as His firstborn Son. Jesus turned around and gave me His standing. That was His glory.

In your natural DNA, even identical twins have variations. Since Adam until now, there has been no other human being with your exact blueprint. If you are that exact and individual in the natural, what is the capacity of a human spirit that just received its life from God?

In my natural man I am multifaceted in capacity and ability. One part of me craved knowledge, but a whole other part of me loved Rosalie. What is the capacity of your spirit? It has the capacity to understand all that God is. It also has the capacity to love with the same love Jesus loved with.

How is it attained? By spending time with Him.

You think fasting kicks you right between the sense ears? Try taking your intellect hostage with seven or eight hours of worship.

When He pours out a little more than my capacity, I cry. I think His grace can help you. I think God's grace is here to strengthen you. I think anything working in me can work in you.

Let me lay hands on you.